

Change Your Family Forever

Financial independence allows you to take care of yourself and your family in ways you've never imagined before. Think back through all the stories we've shared in this book. Can you think of a single millionaire who inherited all their wealth—or even a big piece of their wealth—from their parents? I can't, because none of them did. All the millionaires we featured in this book came from middle-class backgrounds at best and dirt-poor backgrounds at worst. The common denominator isn't how their stories started; it's how they ended. Every one of those people ended the story as millionaire, and that means they have something their parents never did: wealth that will outlive them.

We found that 92% of millionaires plan to pass their wealth to their families. Let's take a look at what that could mean for a typical millionaire family over a few generations. The implications can be mind-blowing. Let's say you started with nothing and built up a \$1 million net worth before you died. You should know by now that this is completely doable for practically anyone. Imagine you have one grown child at that point, and you leave that \$1 million to her as an inheritance. Of course, you would have taught her to work and build wealth herself, so she doesn't necessarily *need* that \$1 million. So she sets it aside and lets it continue to grow. Thirty years later, even if your child never added a dime to that family wealth, that \$1 million would have become an astounding \$17.5 million financial legacy for your grandchildren. If it rolled over one more generation, continuing to grow for another thirty years, your \$1 million would have grown to more than \$304 million! You would have taken your family tree from dirt poor to \$304 million in three generations. This is truly generational wealth. All it takes is for one person—you—to get the ball rolling. From there, momentum and compound interest take over and create an entirely new life for the people you love the most. That's an unbelievable legacy.